

Production Incident Report — PIR-2026-0502

Facility: Lyon-France

Equipment: Homogenizer Unit HMG-03

Reporter: Marc Dupont, Production Supervisor

Date of incident: 2026-05-02

Affected SKUs: SKU-1001, SKU-1002, SKU-1003 (Skincare line — Hydrating Serum, Vitamin C Cream, HA Moisture Boost)

Affected lot: LOT-2026-0502

Units affected: ~5,000 units across the three SKUs

Summary

During the emulsification step on 2026-05-02 at the Lyon facility, Homogenizer Unit HMG-03 exhibited pressure-regulation drift. Gauge readings fluctuated between **2.1 and 2.8 bar** over a 90-minute window while the normal operating range for this product family is 2.4 to 2.6 bar.

Root cause

Calibration drift in the pressure regulation valve **PRV-03B**. The valve had not been serviced since the last quarterly maintenance check (2026-02-15) and had drifted approximately 0.2 bar above nominal. Combined with the higher viscosity of the Skincare Serum / Cream / Treatment formulations on the line that day, the pressure fluctuation translated into inconsistent shear during emulsification.

QC assessment

QC inspector Sophie Martin reviewed a representative sample of 24 units across the three SKUs. The visual and texture inspection revealed:

*"Some units may exhibit minor texture variations due to the pressure fluctuations during emulsification. The variations include slight phase separation visible in the bottle and a grainy or curdled texture when applied. **This is a cosmetic variation only and does not affect product safety or efficacy.** Recommend release for distribution with internal QC note."*

Disposition

RELEASED for distribution per QC recommendation. Internal QC note flagged in lot file. No customer-facing communication issued at the time.

Corrective actions taken

1. Valve PRV-03B replaced 2026-05-03.
2. Calibration check schedule moved from quarterly to monthly for the Lyon Skincare line.
3. Production logs reviewed back through 2026-03; no other affected lots identified.

Notes

Texture complaints on these three SKUs have been customer-visible since approximately 3 weeks after release (post-purchase use). Returns volume from LOT-2026-0502 currently trending 3x normal. Recommend review by VP Operations.